

ASUS ProArt PX 13

A Powerful Creative Laptop — But What Are the Sacrifices?

We have the ASUS ProArt PX 13. As its name suggests, it is a 13-inch creator laptop belonging to ASUS's ProArt lineup. It is 17.7mm thick, it has a 360-degree hinge and a quite beautiful touchscreen OLED display. For the uninitiated, the ProArt lineup offers high-performance tools for creative professionals, tailored for tasks like design, editing, and 3D rendering. The lineup includes products like Motherboards and Graphics cards, displays, desktop computers, and of course laptops. But does it rise up to the challenge?

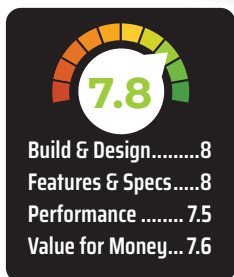
DESIGN, BUILD QUALITY, KEYBOARD AND I/O

The laptop looks like a small, thin, black box. Its rounded edges and the metallic top lid do their best to make the laptop easy to grab onto and keep the design very simple. The laptop gets a decently big enough lip, enough to put all the four fingers, to lift the lid. The base is also just heavy enough to allow you to keep the laptop stable and in its position while you lift the lid with just one hand.

Moreover, the 360-degree is smooth and it doesn't lift up the laptop from the back side even if you place the lid at a steeper angle. You do get the stylus with the laptop and you will find it in the charger box in a separate box of its own. Underneath the laptop, you also get two horizontal strips instead of four separate rubberized feet. They aren't high at all and you will feel that the laptop sits mostly flat on any surface.

The ASUS ProArt PX13 is equipped with versatile I/O ports tailored for

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creators. It features one USB 3.2 Gen 2 Type-A, two USB 4.0 Type-C ports (supporting display output and power delivery), and an HDMI 2.1 for high-res external displays. A 3.5mm audio jack and Micro SD card reader cover audio and data transfer needs, while a DC-in port provides charging.

The keyboard is a 75% layout and includes arrow keys. As an AI-PC, it also has a Windows Co-pilot key. The key travel is around 1.7mm, which is surprisingly high for a 13-inch thin and light laptop. The keyboard is backlit, with three levels of brightness and a function row shared with features like volume and brightness controls, as well as camera and microphone controls.

On the other hand, the touchpad is also decently sized. It distinguishes itself with the integrated ASUS DialPad, a virtual control wheel designed to aid creative workflows. This feature allows users to intuitively adjust settings such as screen brightness, volume, and various parameters within compatible applica-

tions like Adobe Photoshop and Premiere Pro. I have to say that if you already are accustomed to using a mouse to tackle all your creative workflows then chances are that you may not find yourself the ASUS DialPad as much. In my opinion, it's best offered as an optional extra.

DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

The 13-inch OLED display has its ups and downs. It only reaches around 380 nits of peak SDR brightness, which, while good enough for indoor use, isn't nearly sufficient for using outdoors. However, its brilliant contrast ratio, 0.2ms response time, and 2880 X 1800 resolution (255 ppi) make it simply gorgeous to look at. The image it shows is sharp, colour-accurate, and punchy. It goes without saying, but whenever you use this for consuming content, you'll realize you're getting your money's worth every time.

The beautiful display also has a 60Hz panel. On one hand, 60Hz isn't the best choice for gaming in 2024, but considering that the ASUS ProArt PX13 also serves as a creator laptop, the 60Hz refresh rate begins to make sense. The laptop is also equipped with an RTX 4050 laptop GPU with a 95W TGP and 6GB of GDDR6 VRAM. With this setup, a 60Hz refresh rate is sufficient, as few games running at high resolution will reach 60 FPS or beyond. Simply put it is a great machine for content creation, and consumption but not so good for high-intensity gaming.

Moving on to the speakers, I'd say that they are loud but have a small sound stage and the base is also a bit low. The speakers are bottom-firing, so the sound gets muffled if you place the laptop on a soft surface. The audio quality is fine for everyday tasks, but it might fall short for audiophiles or professionals who expect high-fidelity sound.

PERFORMANCE, BENCHMARKS, THERMALS AND BATTERY LIFE

The ASUS ProArt PX13 comes with a CPU which I haven't tested yet. I have tested its bigger cousin the Ryzen AI 9 HX 370. I am of course talking about the Ryzen AI 9 HX 365. Instead of featuring 12 cores, it gets 10